

**Review Report of revised manuscript: BLC-2026-04-0069.R1 (IET Blockchain
Wiley) received 4/6/2026**

Paper title: Cryptographic Chain-of-Custody for Last-Mile Parcel Delivery: A Blockchain–IoT System Architecture with Discrete-Event Simulation Evaluation.

Final decision: **Accept with minor revision.**

Overall Comments:

A lot of work has been done; most comments are about the newly added details and their integration into the original manuscript (detailed there).

Semantic details:

1. On the latency calculations of the simulation (in public blockchains, TXs are coming from everywhere not just your system and hence latency time should be calculated according to the average waiting time for the TX in the minting mempool); also, the TPS numbers are not accurate. The kind of rollup commonly used in this problem (ZK vs. optimistic) is better mentioned and would be more accurate to use its specific metrics. **This should be adjusted first before drawing any conclusions on latency.**
2. I think what is called optimization should be described as a design decision that has an impact on security (if offline data were altered).
3. The threat model have some comments in the manuscript.
4. I advise referring to the limitations section in (<https://www.sciencedirect.com/science/article/pii/S2666691X25000788>, 9/2025) and (<https://www.mdpi.com/2079-8954/14/5/467>, 3/2026, why Maersk failed <https://merehead.com/blog/maersk-blockchain-use-case/>) to discuss how part of their limitations and/or future work is handled in this paper (detailed in the manuscript).
5. Then also discuss the possibilities and effect of: censoring traffic data, IoT producing wrong data with valid signature (their malfunctioning/fault tolerance); how the system will react, whether these are limitations.

Writing details references in the manuscript

1. In many added parts, like case study examples, AES-GCM, Dolev Yao model and other parts details are just written without citing any reference for each case, or even a previous review that holds many in one if this is his true source.
2. Disturbing issue of fake or maybe mixed-up original reference [33]; I will assume it is mixed with another that holds the same title but different authors and publication place (ironically, also numbered [33] in the 2026 Wiley survey mentioned in the previous report).i.e., M.Y. Mofatteh O.F. Valilai, “*A blockchain ecosystem model for a sustainable*

last-mile delivery operation management”,

<https://www.sciencedirect.com/science/article/pii/S2666691X25000788>, 9/2025,

ScienceDirect- Transport Engineering.

3. The abstract is better formed and clarified in this version (but must correct the latency part after delay recalculations). After that, the abstract needs to be updated on the cover (and all other places where it is written in the journal forms).